China, and negotiate them in a manner that limits Chinese flexibility or does not allow the Chinese side to constrain India's position on the specifics of any issue.

If the Chinese are not able to secure their 'principles' early on, they use several tactics to goad the Indian side. One tactic is to allege that the Indian interlocutor is not being faithful to the 'consensus' agreed at the leadership level. The Chinese play on the sense of guilt to dampen the resolve of the Indian negotiator to negotiate the principles. Another tactic is to question the interlocutor's sincerity. The Chinese side will claim that the Indian interlocutor is not being constructive and may be the cause for the breakdown of talks.

This is an intimidatory tactic that puts the fear of failure into the Indian negotiator's mind and keeps her or him under psychological stress. Yet another tactic is to demand explanations for things the Indian side may have said or done. This is a form of harassment or 'shaming' that is aimed at embarrassing the Indian head of delegation in front of his or her delegation. The Chinese also use threat as a form of psychological pressure. Their usual tactic is to refer to unspecified consequences if India does not relent to the Chinese side, with the further caveat that the Indian side shall be responsible for the Chinese retaliation that follows.

Once the principles have been secured, the Chinese will enter into discussion on the specifics. It is common for them to use incremental nibbling techniques (also known as salami-slicing). This enables the Chinese to secure concessions from the opposite number at each step, usually leading up to substantive results when the final agreement is concluded, but without taking excessive risks at any point. [7] Paying close attention to the setting of the agenda could help avoid this situation. Discussion on the specifics, in a step-by-step way, is usually a painful process. The Chinese side tends to repeat its positions